

Francisco Pandol

Backend Tech Lead / Software Project Leader · Python & Node.js / Scalable Systems

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Backend engineering leader with 10+ years delivering scalable systems in fintech, crypto, and real-time platforms. Proven track record delivering end-to-end products, defining architecture, and aligning technical decisions with business impact. Strong focus on performance, scalability, and ownership.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Tech Lead at Dexter Development

Jul 2024 – Present

UniversalCoins Cryptocurrency Exchange

Led end-to-end architecture and technical roadmap for UniversalCoins, a production cryptocurrency exchange built with Python/Django, including Gemini-powered AI agent workflows for the AURA project.

- Led end-to-end architecture and technical roadmap for a production cryptocurrency exchange platform built with Python/Django, focusing on scalability, security, and reliable transaction processing.
- Designed and implemented high-concurrency REST APIs using Django/DRF for real-time financial transactions, following secure coding and backend engineering practices.
- Built an AI agent powered by Gemini with tool calling, integrating LLM-driven workflows with backend services and application capabilities for the AURA project.
- Developed AI-assisted engineering workflows with Claude Code, using agent-based workflows to automate development, code analysis, and engineering tasks across the UniversalCoins codebase.
- Established CI/CD pipelines and engineering practices supporting reliable deployments, high availability, and rapid product iteration.
- Integrated Fireblocks for secure digital-asset custody and MetaMap for KYC/AML identity verification, supporting security-critical financial workflows.
- Designed asynchronous and event-driven backend workflows using Celery, supporting scalable processing and operational reliability.
- Built and operated AWS infrastructure using ECS/Fargate, Docker, RDS, and CloudWatch, with a focus on production reliability, observability, and scalability.

Senior Backend Engineer at AgioRatings

Dec 2023 – Mar 2024

Financial Anomaly Detection System

Built high-performance APIs with FastAPI for real-time financial data analysis and deployed scalable solutions on Azure.

- Built high-performance APIs with FastAPI for real-time financial data analysis.
- Designed anomaly detection systems for exchange monitoring.
- Implemented async processing pipelines for high-volume data streams.
- Deployed scalable solutions on Azure with CI/CD automation.

Senior Backend Engineer at GLASFunds

Aug 2022 – Oct 2023

GLASFunds Wealth Management Platform

Developed scalable backend systems for financial tools on Django with strong focus on database performance and horizontal scaling on GCP.

- Developed scalable backend systems for financial tools using Django.
- Optimized database performance reducing query time by 40%+.

- Implemented horizontal scaling on GCP for high availability.

Senior Software Engineer at Apptim

Feb 2021 – Jul 2022

Apptim Mobile App Performance Analysis Platform

Performance analysis platform work spanning Python backend services and an Electron + Vite desktop client for mobile app profiling.

- Developed Python backend services for iOS and Android performance analysis and CI data collection.
- Built Electron + Vite desktop tooling for mobile app performance workflows.
- Led migration from Python 2 to Python 3 across backend services.
- Automated testing pipelines with AWS Device Farm and GitHub Actions.

Backend Tech Lead at RealTrends

Feb 2019 – Feb 2021

RealTrends Business Intelligence Platform

Led backend team building an analytics platform for MercadoLibre sellers with event-driven architecture and strong product collaboration.

- Led backend team (4–6 engineers) building analytics platform for MercadoLibre sellers.
- Designed event-driven architecture and real-time systems.
- Reduced system latency by 60%+ through async processing.
- Collaborated with product to define roadmap and priorities.

Lead Node.js Engineer at Al Pelo

Jan 2018 – Feb 2019

On-Demand Delivery Platform (0 → MVP)

Lead Engineer for an on-demand delivery platform (0 → MVP): founded and led the engineering team, defined NestJS backend architecture, and shipped a production-ready MVP.

- Founded and led the engineering team, defining NestJS modular backend architecture from scratch.
- Designed a scalable real-time dispatch and logistics system with WebSockets and event-driven services.
- Built AWS-based infrastructure (S3, RDS, SQS, SNS) integrated via NestJS providers for resilience and asynchronous processing.
- Delivered a production-ready MVP optimized for scalability and future feature expansion.

Python Lead Developer at PredictionLabs

Jul 2016 – Nov 2017

Bitcoin Exchange Platform

Backend tech lead for a cryptocurrency exchange platform: architecture, APIs, admin systems, and security for financial transactions.

- Designed and implemented backend architecture for a Bitcoin exchange platform, including APIs and admin systems.
- Developed advanced security mechanisms (MFA, identity verification) to protect financial transactions.
- Managed secure transactional data storage using PostgreSQL and MongoDB.
- Established engineering standards and best practices to ensure system stability and scalability.

Django Instructor at Catamarca Government & Technology Cluster

Nov 2016 – Jun 2017

Catamarca Government & Technology Cluster

Django instructor for a technical training program: intensive backend development curricula and mentoring.

- Designed and delivered intensive backend development training programs using Django.
- Mentored professionals on best practices, system design, and scalable architecture.

- Promoted adoption of modern development standards and engineering practices.

Technical Consultant at Argentina National Ministry of Economy

Jan 2015 – Dec 2015

Official Catamarca Government Platform

Technical consultant on government digital platforms: secure, compliant systems and stakeholder alignment.

- Led development of secure government platforms with high compliance and reliability requirements.
- Designed systems with multi-layer authentication and data encryption for sensitive information.
- Implemented scalable AWS-based solutions aligned with regulatory standards.
- Collaborated with non-technical stakeholders to translate business requirements into technical solutions.

Software Engineer (Freelance) at Custom Software Solutions

Jan 2013 – Dec 2015

Custom Software Solutions

Freelance delivery of backend and mobile solutions with CI/CD and agile execution across clients.

- Delivered backend and mobile solutions for multiple clients across different industries.
- Designed adaptable architectures based on diverse business requirements.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines and agile workflows for efficient delivery.
- Integrated mobile applications with scalable backend services (Firebase, Parse).